Generative AI Immersion

WRITING & DOCUMENTATION

MODULE 03

At the end of this module, you will be able to:

1. Draft, rewrite, summarize, and publish texts and documents using generative AI tools.
2. Convert messy notes and transcripts to clean documentation.
3. Control the tone and style of professional documentation and texts.
4. Structure long documents such as reports and proposals.
5. Understand the documentation required in technology and business use cases.

Why Use AI for Writing/Documentation?

The Value Proposition: Speed, scale, cost efficiency, consistency, ideation support, cognitive leverage, documentation standardization, and knowledge capture.

- Reduces errors in grammar, tone, and structure. Sharpens the writeup for target audiences.
- Balances the tone, depth, and structure towards a goal, rather than just generating text.
- Accelerates the process, which is traditionally slow and manual. E.g., sometimes we spend ~15 minutes drafting a single email, deciding its subject line, etc. AI can shorten the process drastically.
- Writing often needs some amount of research. AI can completely substitute the research stage and cite sources from where it picked the data.
- AI allows us to create more documentation faster, which enables teams to have a shared understanding of their products and services, collaborate better, and maintain consistency.

What Types Of Documents Can AI Create

The Scope of Application

Rule: When prompting AI, define what exactly needs to be produced (document type, scope, format), which reduces ambiguity and prevents irrelevant output.

AI can create any type of document that we need, such as:

1. Communication Documents (Emails, Social Media Posts, Blogs, Case Studies, etc.)
2. Strategic and Business Documentation (Business Plans, Pitch Decks, SWOT Analyses, etc.)
3. Product and Technical Documentation (PRDs, API Documentation, User Manuals, etc.)
4. Personal and Productivity Documents (Resume, CVs, Cover Letters, Goal-Setting Plans, etc.)

...and many more.

Individual Activity

Description: Describe your role to a Large Language Model (Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity) and the activities that you undertake to fulfill your role. Then ask the AI what kinds of documents it can create to either help with what you already create manually or entirely new documents that will add more value to your work.

Sample Prompt: I am currently working as a <insert-role> at the <insert-institution> in <insert-place>. My day-to-day consists of writing/documenting <item1>, <item2>, <item3>, and I am also responsible for <insert-responsibilities>. Suggest necessary documents that you can help me create, based on international standards, to fulfill my role, and suggest other documents that you can help me create that can add more value to my team and organization.

When to use AI for Writing/Documentation

The Decision Trigger – Under what conditions should AI be used vs avoided.

Use AI:

1. When speed matters more than originality.
2. When structure is known, but content needs generation.
3. When dealing with repetitive or templated documentation.
4. When summarizing large volumes of information.
5. When document debt is high.
6. When consistency across teams is required.

Don't Use AI when legal liability is high, confidentiality is sensitive, of factual precision cannot tolerate hallucination.

How to Use AI for Writing/Documentation

The operating model: Prompt engineering, structured templates, iterative drafting, review loops, human in the loop (HITL) validation, fact-checking, style enforcement, and versioning discipline.

Process 1: Draft (Human) > Transform (AI) > Fact-Check & Revise (Human) > Polish (AI)

Process 2: Generate (AI) > Fact-Check & Revise > Polish (AI)

Iterate as many times as needed.

Mandatory: Human in the Loop. You should never use AI generated content directly without at-least one revision.

Risks: AI Slop; tools can determine % of text that's AI generated.

Example – Process 1

Step 1 - Initial Draft (Human)

The AI landscape is rapidly changing, with the capabilities increasing multifold every year. At this rate, we can only predict that in a few years, the job market will look completely different from what it is today. Since AI is a horizontal technology, it will affect every industry and sector. The best way for companies to protect themselves is to adopt AI and re-innovate their entire value chain. Those who do not will perish.

Step 2 - Transform

Use this draft to create a 1-page report on the state of AI globally for a blog post. The readers are professionals from different industries.

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Tools

Thinking

Example – Process 1

Step 3: Revise & Fact-Check. Add the human touch.

Step 4: Repeat step 2 and 3 until you are satisfied with the output.

Step 5: Publish your blog.

https://ankit611.medium.com/the-great-convergence-the-state-of-ai-in-2026-a453ec47717f

Who is Writing and for Whom?

The human roles interacting with AI

If AI is writing the document, why should it care who the human is?

Because **the role determines authority, context depth, accountability, and risk tolerance** — and those variables directly shape how the document must be written.

1. **Domain depth and vocabulary precision**: An engineer reviewing your document expects the technical details, but a product manager expects business aspects.
2. **Decision rights and accountability**: A legal reviewer operates under liability exposure. A marketer tolerates creative framing and persuasive tone. The acceptable risk profile is different.
3. **Objective of the document**: Is it meant to persuade, approve, implement, audit, or inform? The writer's role usually defines the document's function within an organization.

Who is Writing and for Whom?

1. **Assumed prior knowledge**: If the reader (target audience) is a technical architect, AI can omit foundational explanations. If the audience is cross-functional, it must translate jargon. Without role clarity, AI either over-explains or under-explains.
2. **Review burden and validation requirements**: If a senior engineer is supervising AI output, they can validate technical accuracy. If a junior associate is using AI, the document must be more structured, conservative, and easier to verify.

In short: Role defines abstraction level, risk tolerance, decision context, vocabulary, and validation rigor. If AI does not know who is writing and for whom, it writes generically. Generic documentation is the enemy of professional environments.

"AI does not just need the topic. It needs the authority context."

Where will this Document Live?

The integration layer.

The destination of a document decides format, structure, constrains, and compliance expectations. If AI does not know the destination context, it cannot optimize the output.

Permanence level changes rigor – If the document becomes part of an official knowledge base or regulatory archive, ambiguity and speculative phrasing are unacceptable. If it is an internal brainstorming draft, exploratory tone is fine.

Audience access scope matters – Internal wiki vs public website vs investor deck vs customer-facing manual — each changes tone, confidentiality level, and legal exposure.

In structured terms, the place decides format, tone, compliance standard, structural conventions, and risk exposure.

Bringing it all Together

Prompt: Give me an example prompt that combines all the variables like what, why, who, where, etc. to create an academic report for graduate-level Tech CPD students in Butajira, Ethiopia.

Draft a 3,000-word academic research report analyzing the potential of perennial, revenue-generating agroforestry systems to improve food security, soil health, and income resilience in Butajira, Ethiopia. The purpose is to produce context-specific, evidence-based analysis suitable for graduate evaluation. The authors are graduate-level Tech CPD students in Butajira, writing for faculty and interdisciplinary peers. Structure the report with abstract, introduction, literature review, methodology, analysis, discussion, limitations, conclusion, and APA references. Use formal academic tone, define technical terms where needed, avoid fabricated sources, and apply critical comparison of relevant sustainability and economic frameworks.

Risks

Governance of a rapidly developing technology poses challenges for organizations, and CXOs have to ensure that the risks posed by AI systems are properly addressed.

1. **Hallucination**: AI can confidently generate incorrect, outdated, or invented facts, which is especially dangerous in requirements, contracts, SOPs, or compliance documents.
2. **Loss of intent and accountability**: When documents are AI-written but not clearly owned, teams stop asking "why this exists," leading to shallow alignment and decision abdication.
3. **Garbage-in, garbage-out prompts**: Poorly framed prompts produce documents that look polished but are structurally wrong—masking weak thinking rather than fixing it.
4. **Over-standardization and loss of context**: AI tends to average patterns, which can erase edge cases, local realities, regulatory nuances, or cultural context critical to real operations.
5. **IP, confidentiality, and data leakage**: Using sensitive inputs (contracts, source code, customer data) without governance can expose proprietary or regulated information.

Risks

- **Skill atrophy and dependency**: Teams may lose the ability to write, reason, or document independently, weakening long-term organizational competence.
- **False sense of speed and completeness**: AI makes documents fast, not correct; teams may confuse velocity with progress and skip validation or stakeholder review.
- **Bias and embedded assumptions**: Training data biases can seep into policy language, hiring docs, user-facing content, or decision frameworks.
- **Versioning and truth decay**: AI-generated documents can multiply rapidly, creating conflicting "sources of truth" without strong document governance.
- **Legal and compliance exposure**: Unreviewed AI-generated language in contracts, disclosures, or regulated documentation can create real legal liability.

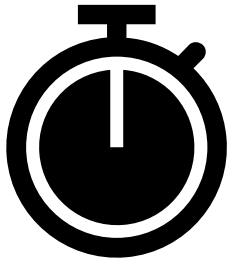
Mitigation Strategies

Organizations across the world are creating policies to mitigate risks posed by Generative AI.

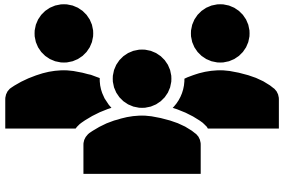
- Human-in-the-loop review for high-stakes docs
- Clear document ownership and approval flows
- Explicit prompts that encode intent and constraints
- AI usage policies by document type
- Treat AI as a *drafting and thinking partner*, not an authority

Metrics to Measure Effectiveness

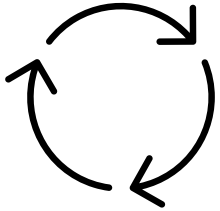
How to measure AI documentation effectiveness.



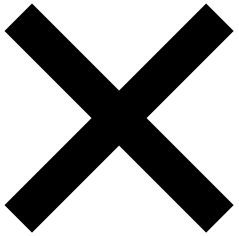
Time Saved



Adoption Rate



Revision Cycles



Error Rate Reduction

Use Cases

Use cases are actual problems that are solved by the documentation/writing capabilities of AI. Broadly, there are three classes, creation, summarization, and transformation. More specifically,

1. **Creation** (generation) from scratch.
2. **Summarizing** a document without losing its meaning.
3. **Transformation** of an existing document.
4. **Expanding** (elaborating) an existing document by adding more material, depth, etc.
5. **Analysis & Critique** of a piece of document/write-up.
6. **Extraction & Structuring** of messy notes to structured outputs.

Summarizing Long Documents

1. Goals for summarizing (the why):
   - Communication,
   - Personal understanding,
   - Market research, etc.
2. Output Format:
   - Bulleted lists.
   - Paragraphs with page/word count.
   - Table differentiating the pros and the cons.

Structuring Messy Inputs to Thoughts

Systematically convert this messy meeting notes into structured minutes (summary, decisions, risks, action items, owners, deadlines.

Example:

- budget issues again — marketing overspent? need clarity from finance, Tsion said numbers don’t match last month sheet
- launch date?? was 15 March but dev says backend not stable, maybe push 2–3 weeks
- customer complaints increasing re: slow dashboard + mobile bugs (esp Android)
- Woliyou hiring 2 interns? unclear timeline, HR approval pending
- partnership with local NGO in Butajira — good PR + field data access, but legal concerns
- investor update deck not ready, Solomon to revise slides (impact metrics missing)
- data privacy policy outdated — needs review before scaling to new region
- someone mentioned competitor dropped prices 20% last week?? need verification
- sustainability angle not highlighted enough in comms, important for grants
- next sprint priorities confusing — backend fixes vs new feature rollout debate

Practical Use Cases

1. Writing a blog post (Medium, Substack, WordPress)
2. Writing a LinkedIn post (Professional Storyboard)
3. Author an academic/professional report (work, school)
4. Create your resume bullet points.
5. Create customized cover letters.
6. Create technical documentation.
7. Create leadership plans.

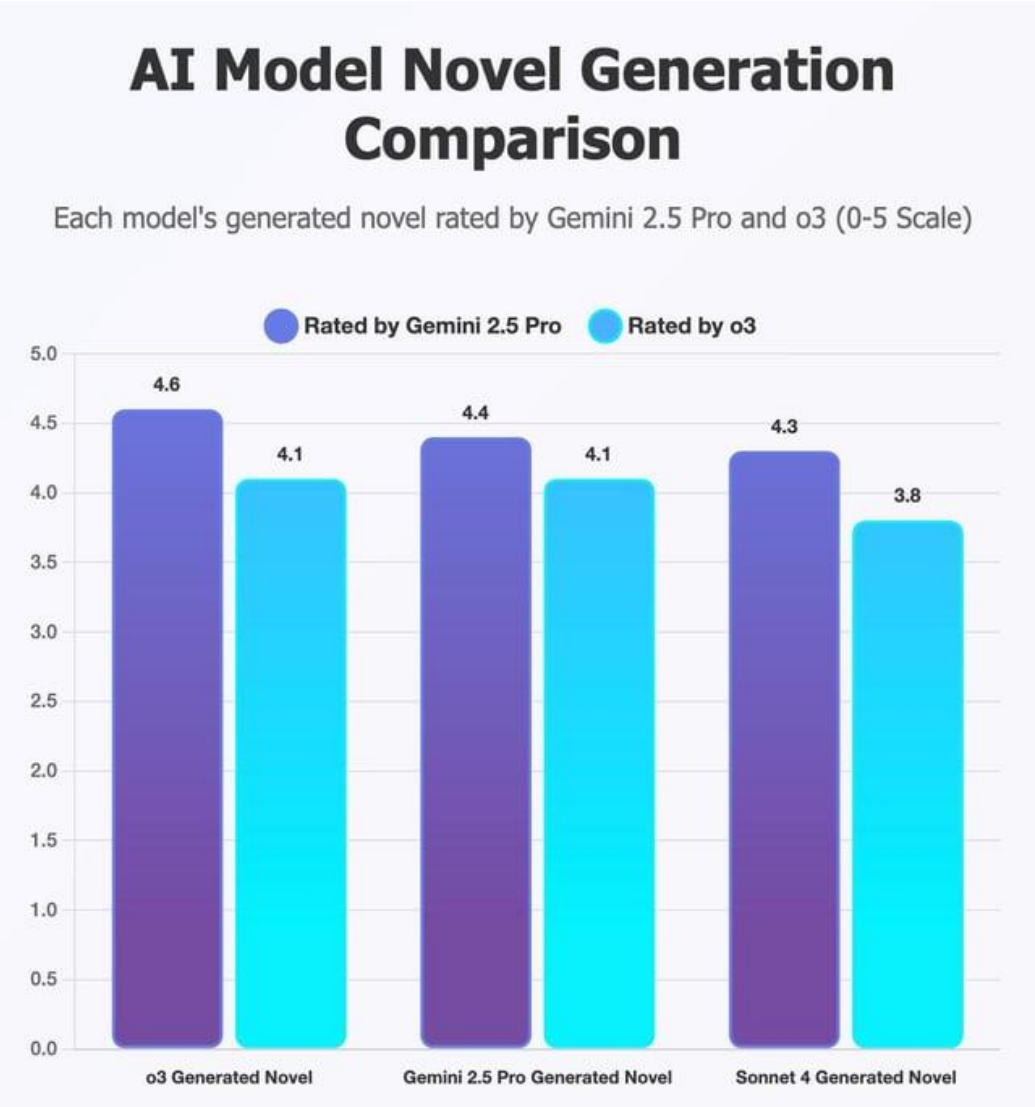
Tools for Writing

ChatGPT

Perplexity

Gemini

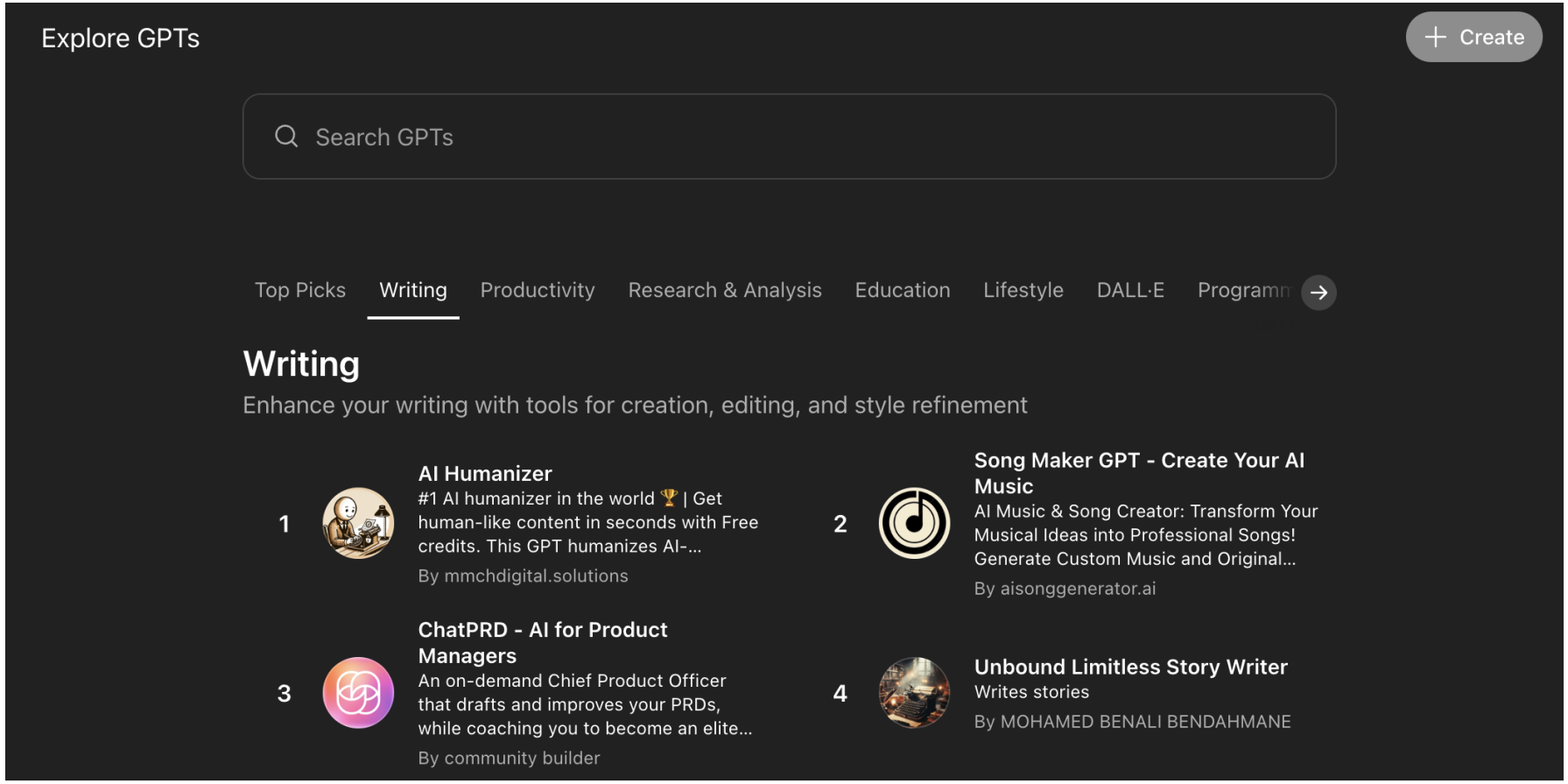
Grammarly



Comparing AI models on generating novels.

Leveraging Custom GPTs

Dive deep into ChatGPT. Learn how to leverage custom GPTs built by community members for specific tasks.



Next Steps

Read: https://zapier.com/blog/best-ai-writing-generator/

Visit: https://artificialanalysis.ai/leaderboards/models

Appendices

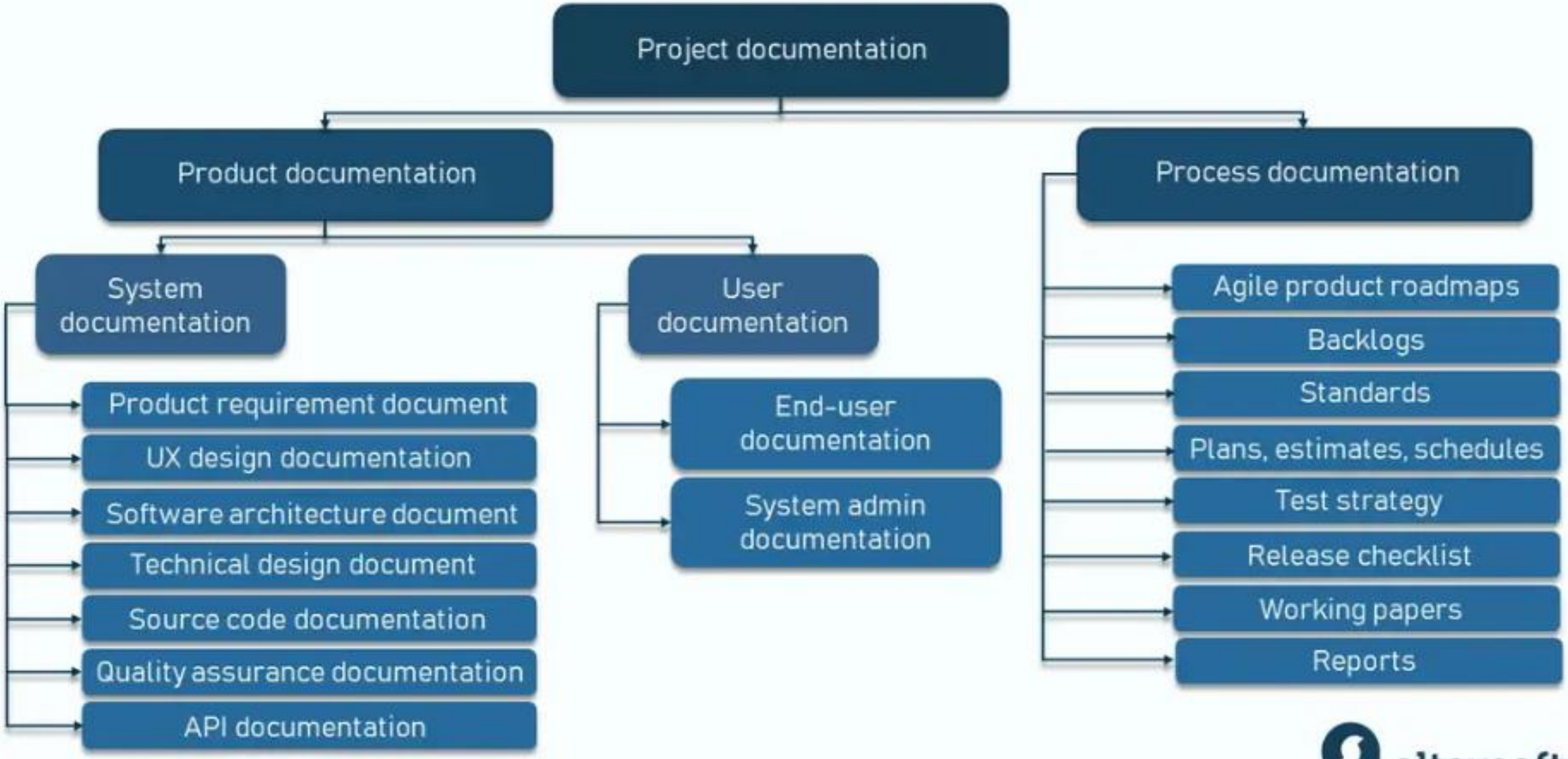
These appendices contain information that is vital for every professional working at the intersection of business and technology to learn and internalize. We specifically talk about the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) and the Business Value Chain.

Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

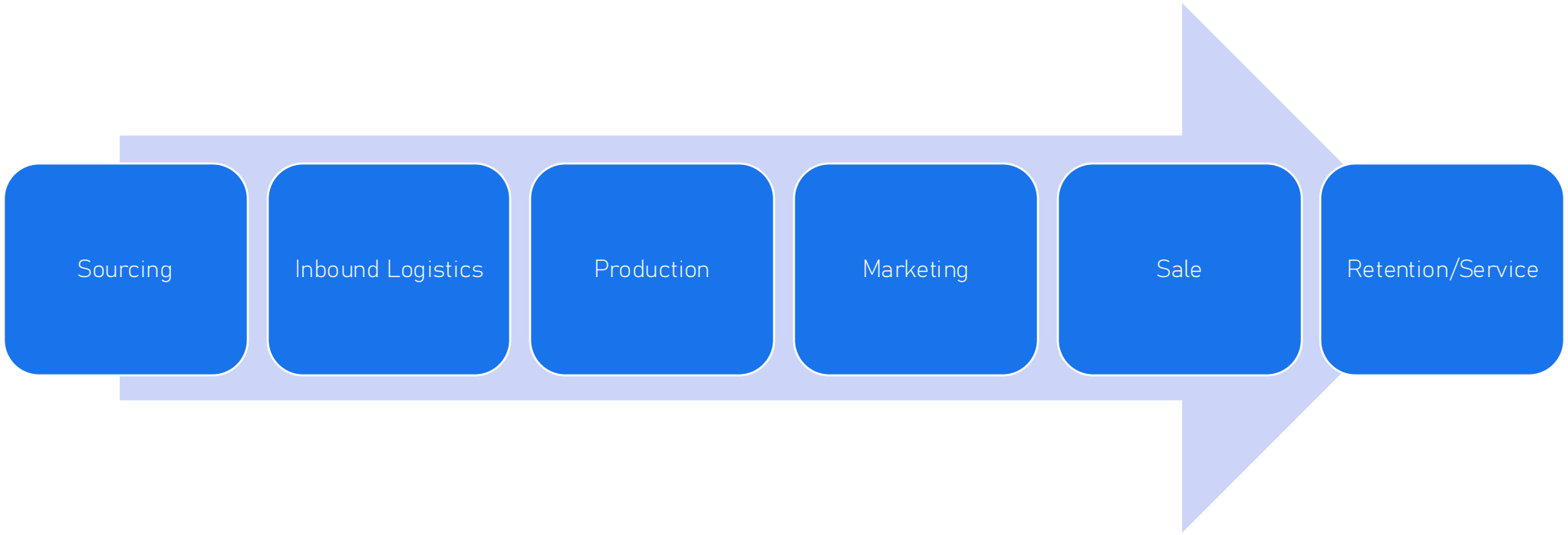
From the earlier Waterfall model to the current Agile model, software development has become more responsive and less rigid. Read More.

- **Decide** (Planning & Requirement Analysis) – What problem to solve and why
- **Design** – What to build and how
- **Build** (Coding) – Create the technology
- **Test** – Make sure it works
- **Launch** – Put it in users' hands
- **Operate** – Keep it reliable and secure
- **Learn** – Improve based on data and feedback

SOFTWARE TECH DOCUMENTATION TYPES



Business Value Chain



Artificial Intelligence reduces friction by creating, structuring, validating, and summarizing documents at every handoff point in the business value chain.